

WEEKLY BULLETIN

4 December 2017



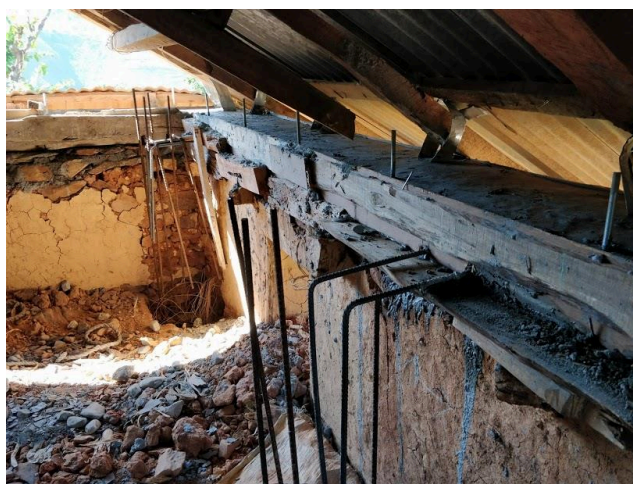
Ramechhap District: a new house being constructed in front of the existing damaged house. The new house is significantly smaller than the existing damaged house. The need for retrofitting support in some areas is very urgent.
Photo credit: Magnus Wolfe Murray/DFID.



Retrofitting in Purano village, Sindhuli district. This is one of the first On the Job Training masons training on retrofitting. It is being implemented by Build Change and a local NGO Rural Infrastructure Management, under a DFID funded project. Photo credit: Magnus Wolfe Murray/DFID.



Retrofitting in Purano village, Sindhuli district. Photo credit: Magnus Wolfe Murray/DFID.



Retrofitting in Purano village, Sindhuli district. Photo credit: Magnus Wolfe Murray/DFID.

Highlights

- The second phase of the [House of Representatives and Provincial Assembly Elections](#) takes place on Thursday, 7 December. Partners are required to abide by the election [code of conduct](#).
- [Invitation: HRRP General Meeting & District Exhibition, 13 December](#)
- Launch of MoFALD Local Governance Website, Mobile App, and Knowledge Management Blog ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#))
- MoFALD Official Notice Regarding Partner Agreements (between GoN and eligible households) and Disbursement of Grant Payments ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#))
- [NRA Office Opened in Lamjung \(Nepali\)](#)
- [460 newly hired NRA engineers deployed across the 31 districts](#) and two trainings for newly hired NRA sub-engineers and assistant sub-engineers took place on 1-2 December and 3-4 December.
- [High-Level Interaction Programme on the Post Flood Recovery Needs Assessment, 1 December](#)
- ASF Nepal are offering free sessions on timber treatment for POs and other stakeholders, anyone interested can contact Salena Sangachhe, 9849603383 / prog.man2.asfnepal@gmail.com.

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

Second Phase of House of Representatives and Provincial Assembly Elections: on Thursday, 7 December, voting will take place in 45 districts, with over 120 million people registered to vote. Across all districts, partners have been requested to suspend all activities, “including but not limited to trainings, workshops, or physical constructions that are being implemented”, which “may adversely affect the elections”, and are required to abide by the election [code of conduct](#).

MoFALD Official Notice Regarding Partner Agreements (with eligible households) and Disbursement of Grant Payments (Nepali, Unofficial English Translation): the notice provides details of decisions taken at various NRA Executive Committee meetings to address issues at local level regarding partner agreements between GoN and eligible households and disbursement of tranche payments.

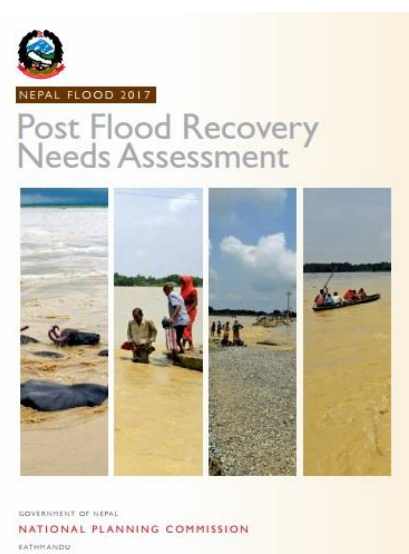
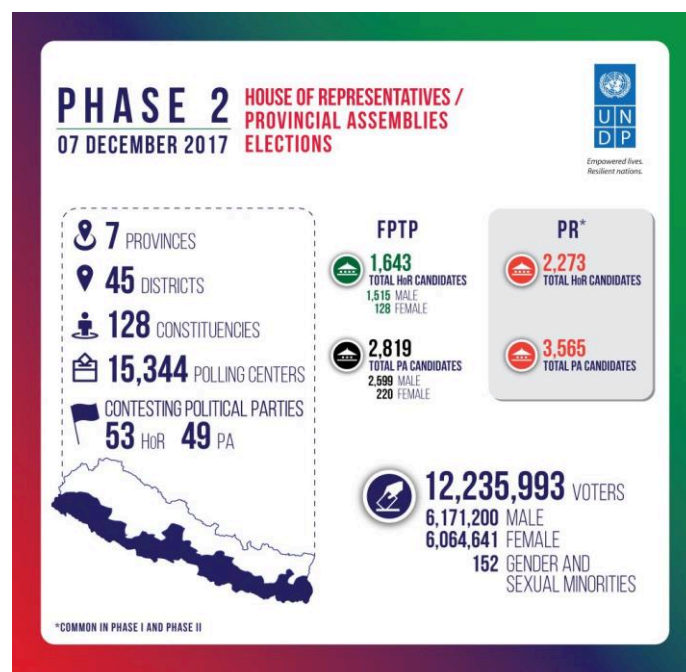
NRA Office Opened in Lamjung (Nepali): the office has been established to support the grant disbursement process and to ensure that the grievance process proceeds smoothly.

Relocation Process Starts in Urleni Village, Nuwakot: the geo-hazard risk survey conducted by NRA identified 71 houses in Urleni village as being on ‘category 3’, or at risk land. 24 of these households have already started their relocation process and have purchased a new plot of land in a safe place using the 200,000 NPRs grant available from the NRA for this process.

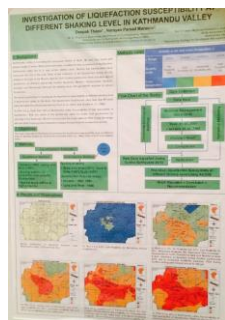
High-Level Interaction Programme on the Post Flood Recovery Needs Assessment, 1 December: the National Planning Commission (NPC), UNDP, and the World Bank brought development partners together for this event to present the findings of the assessment and the flood recovery cell under the NRA. The session was chaired by Dr. Swarnim Wagle, NPC Vice Chairman and included high level participants from the UN RCO, Ministry for Finance, NRA, and World Bank.

Oxfam Launches Trans-Boundary Water Governance Project in Nepal: the five-year programme will promote improved policies and practices to protect the rights of communities in four districts along the Mahakali River Basin. The programme will work with governments, private sector, and other actors as well as women’s networks to strengthen their voice in decision making on water management and infrastructure. The project will be implemented in India, Nepal, Bangladesh and Myanmar.

ADB to Provide \$150 million Loan for Urban Development: the agreement signed on Monday 27 November between the ADB and Ministry of Finance, sees the ADB provide the loan to to enhance sustainable urban development and attain balanced regional development in eight municipalities in southern Tarai and far-western



parts of Nepal (Birgunj, Biratnagar, Siddharthanagar, Nepalgunj, Bheemdatta, Dhangadhi, Godawari, and Shuklaphanta). The project will enhance urban infrastructure; reducing flooding duration to less than an hour in eight municipalities through construction and rehabilitation of 200 km of storm water drains, as well as improvement of 240 km of roads, and construction of at least 40 km of footpaths, four sanitary landfills, resource recovery centers, and 20 km of sewers.



11th Asia Regional Conference of the International Association for Engineering Geology and the Environment (IAEG): the event was a huge success, bringing together national and international (from more than 30 countries) experts to discuss and share experiences on earthquake induced geohazards and damage, and the progress in Nepal on recovery following the 2015 Gorkha Earthquake. There were 240 presentations and 100 poster presentations presented in across different thematic sessions during the event. The HRRP National Technical Coordinator, Narayan Marasini, presented two papers as an author and co-author and won the best Poster Presentation for “Investigation of Liquefaction Susceptibility at Different Shaking Level in Kathmandu Valley” – Congratulations Narayan!

MoFALD CLPIU Enrolment Data, 30 November (Nepali):

			No. of beneficiaries added after grievances redressal	Total no. of beneficiaries	No. of HHs with grant agreement	No. of HHs received 1st tranche			No. of HHs received 2nd tranche			No. of HHs received 3rd tranche			No. of grievances registered	No. of grievances cleared	No. of beneficiaries eligible for retrofitting grant
S.N.	Districts	No. of Eligible HHs				GoN	I/NGO	Total	GoN	I/NGO	Total	GoN	I/NGO	Total			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7			8			9			10	11	12
Cluster 1- Highly affected 14 Districts																	
1	Sindhupalchok	78537	5126	83663	75765	71197	4455	75652	13726	1646	15372	1572	906	2478	14447	10838	376
2	Okhaldhunga	19819	346	20165	18899	18377	505	18882	5111	256	5367	1858	134	1992	8019	7810	1643
3	Nuwakot	65773	3516	69289	62825			62825			11020			1028	11503	11416	936
4	Ramechhap	43609	1431	45040	42440	41119	1285	42404	7950	610	8560	766	430	1196	14005	13972	2149
5	Dolakha	51940	10893	62833	55192	51696	1692	53388	11812	1405	13217	2233	933	3166	24379	24379	637
6	Gorkha	58503	2813	61316	54521	54521		54521	9540	553	10093	2548	361	2909	1164		2019
7	Dhading	70581	2759	73340	67154	66732		66732	8225		8225	913		913	17044	16577	1494
8	Kavrepalanchok	67731	4689	72420	64012	61598	2414	64012	6444	502	6946	15	213	228	23939	23486	2415
9	Rasuwa	11236	397	11633	10700	8875	1023	9898	1348	581	1929	521	470	991	1418	1288	117
10	Sindhuli	34269	719	34988	30723	29860	863	30723	4257	534	4791	110	315	425	28627	28627	2408
11	Makwanpur	30238	1579	31817	23333	21377	1361	22738	4233	846	5079	397	705	1104	23961	23919	4150
12	Kathmandu	42500	3300	45800	37162	37036	107	37143	2010	0	2010	101		101	11296	11296	575
13	Lalitpur	25893	1821	27714	22071	20528	756	21284	874	532	1406	74	427	501	7004	5882	667
14	Bhaktapur	26066	1578	27644	22463	22230		22230	1405		1405	60		60	6340	6330	280
Sub-total		626695	40967	667662	587260			582432			95420			17092	193146	185820	19866
Cluster 2 - Less affected 17 Districts																	
1	Sankhuwasabha	1953		1953	1583	1201		1201			0						326
2	Bhojpur	5749		5749	4500	3082		3082			0				8000		453
3	Dhankuta	2796		2796	2252	2252		2252			0						70
4	Khotang	8443		8443	7985	7985		7985			0						253
5	Solukhumbu	11979		11979	8095	6021		6021			0						456
6	Chitwan	7335		7335	5110	4960		4960									593
7	Nawalparasi	872		872	823	823		823			0				143		8
8	Tanahu	13821		13821	10145	9595		9595			0						466
9	Lamjung	13959		13959	13084	12361	200	12561		75	75				3042		539
10	Baglung	2375		2375	1107	1109		1109			0						82
11	Syangja	8766		8766	5342	4340		4340			0						567
12	Palpa	4652		4652	3500	1946		1946			0						384
13	Parbat	5269		5269	4138	4070		4070			0						417
14	Gulmi	4144		4144	2877	2068		2068			0						195
15	Kaski	6026		6026	4393	4393		4393			0						242
16	Arghakhachi	1036		1036	850	591		591			0						67
17	Myagdi	868		868	645	645		645			0						7
Sub-total		100043		100043	76429	67442	200	67642	0	75	75	0	0	0	11185	0	5125
Total		726738	40967	767705	663689	67442	200	650074	0	75	95495	0	0	17092	204331	185820	24991

NRA 5W Reporting: to date 150 out of 154 (97%) POs have reported to the NRA 5W. We understand that many POs who have already reported are having issues with logging in to, and using the reporting system. HRRP is working with NRA to address these issues. If your organisation is facing any issues reporting to the 5W, please contact Keshab Shrestha (im.national@hrrpnepal.org). Once the NRA 5W is fully up and running the HRRP 4W will be phased out.

Districts

Deployment of new NRA Engineers across 31 Districts: following completion of 10 days training on Earthquake Resilient Building Construction, 460 newly hired NRA engineers have been deployed across the 31 districts. The engineers took an oath in the presence of the NRA CEO on Sunday before travelling to their working locations.

Training for Newly Hired NRA Sub-engineers and Assistant Sub-engineers: 460 sub-engineers and 460 assistant sub-engineers, newly hired by NRA, are being provided with two days training before being deployed across the 31 districts. The training took place on 1-2 December for sub-engineers and 3-4 December for assistant sub-engineers. The training was organised by the NRA and MoUD CLPIU, with financial support from the World Bank. HRRP, NSET, Build Change, and JICA have provided support for the development of the curricula as well as providing trainers.

Old but not Forgotten, Sheltering Nepal's Most Vulnerable, Medair, Ramechhap: the story of an elderly couple, Dolma and Sarmalal, from Bijulikot in Ramechhap who were initially afraid to invest their savings in rebuilding their home as they were unsure of the process. Through socio-technical assistance provided by Medair, and with encouragement from their son, the couple have now rebuilt their home and moved out of their temporary shelter.



Dolma at the temporary shelter that she and her husband Sarmalal lived in after the 2015 earthquake destroyed their home. Photo credit: Tamara Berger/Medair.



Dolma and Sarmalal outside their son's reconstructed home. Their son, who received masons training from Medair, worked on constructing their home after completing his. Photo credit: Wendy van Amerongen/Medair.

Infrastructure and Livelihood Recovery, People in Need, Gorkha: Chinmaya Gurung, pictured, is one of over 2,000 local people who worked on the UK Aid funded 'Unnat Goreto' project. The project supported rehabilitation of 125 km of trails in remote areas of Gorkha and Rasuwa and was implemented by People in Need. Chinmaya, from Kerauja in Gorkha, worked on the trail project for almost 50 days and earned 50,000 NPRs. She invested the money she earned in her children's education as well as being able to save some of the earnings in the local women's co-cooperative. Chinmaya was particularly happy that women were paid the same as men for their work on the trails project as this is not normally the case.



Photo Credit: Sajana Shrestha/People in Need.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 24 - 30 Nov 2017



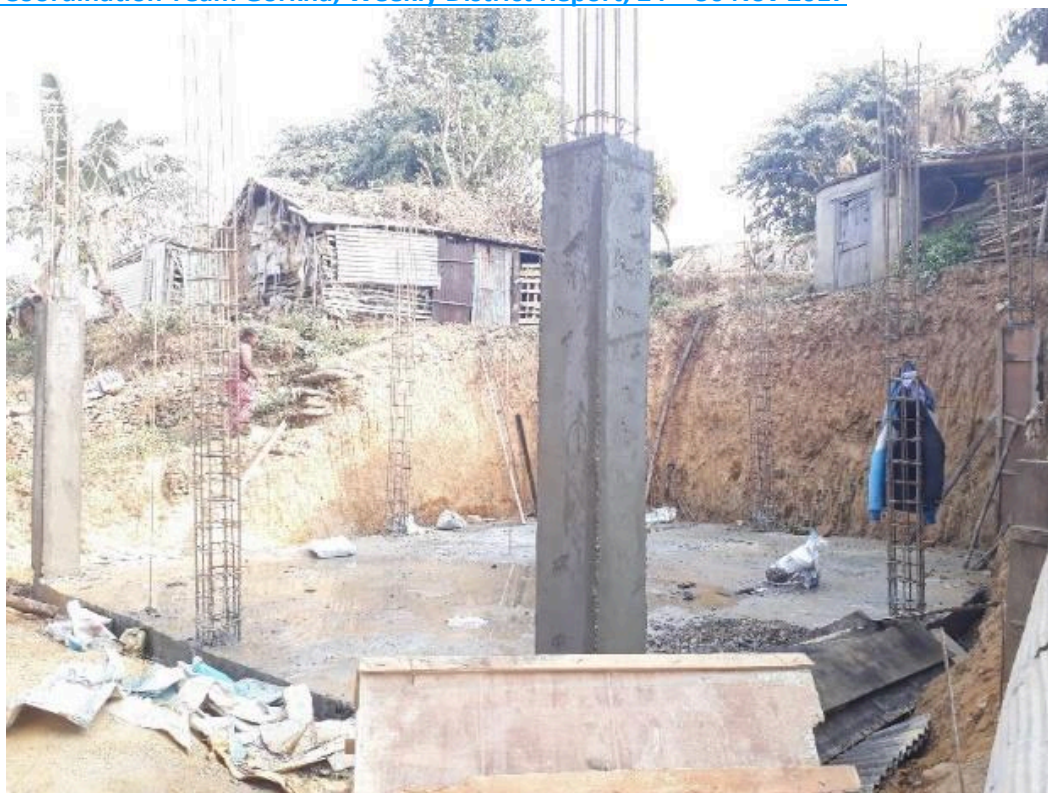
Jugal Rural Municipality (Gumba VDC), Sindhupalchok: the home owner has received all three tranches after going making corrections required to achieve compliance. Initially the room size was greater than allowed so the home owner had to construct cross walls and add vertical timber members in the attic. When this was completed the house was inspected and approved by the engineer.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Weekly District Report, 24 - 30 Nov 2017](#)



Bhusunga VDC, Okhaldhunga: this house has been constructed using stone and mud mortar masonry with timber banding. The home owner has received all three tranches.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 24 – 30 Nov 2017](#)



Tandrang-3, Gorkha: this house being constructed using RCC has met all the required specifications and standards and the home owner has had regular consultation with the inspection engineers. The home owner is waiting for all the columns to be cast before applying for the second tranche.

Requests for Partner Support

[Invitation: HRRP General Meeting & District Exhibition, 13 December](#)

Preparations for the 20th Earthquake Safety Day: the first planning meeting for Earthquake Safety Day (ESD) 2018 took place on Thursday, 30 November. The meeting notes, presentation slides, and a brief concept note on the focus for the ESD (Safe Home Campaign) are available [here](#). Partners are requested to share information on activities planned to mark ESD 2018 using the format available [here](#). The completed forms should be returned to Khadga Sen Oli, ksenoli@nset.org.np, by 10 December at the latest.

ASF Nepal Offering Free Sessions on Timber Treatment for POs and Households: ASF Nepal is planning an awareness campaign on timber treatment for sustainable reconstruction. As part of this Partner Organisations will be able to receive free sessions on timber treatment (covering advantages of timber treatment, potential treatment methods, and other relevant information) for their staff as well as for households / other stakeholders in their working areas. Interested POs can contact Salena Sangachhe, 9849603383 / prog.man2.asfnepal@gmail.com, for further information and to organise the sessions.



Timber treatment process. Photo credit: ASF Nepal.

HRRP 4W Review: HRRP periodically revises the 4W and related collection tools to better reflect the needs of implementers. A review has just been launched and as part of this HRRP is engaging in a series of bilateral consultations with reconstruction actors to understand their needs and internal data collection processes. This will allow changes being made to better align with partner processes and priorities. If you are interested to organise a bilateral consultation for your organisation, or to share feedback, you can contact the HRRP MEAL Coordinator, Rupa Pandey, meal@hrrpnepal.org.

Data Collection, Cost of Construction: many thanks to NSET, CRS, Medair, and United Mission to Nepal who have already shared cost of construction data. We expect to share the first round of the cost of construction database this week. HRRP would like to request Partner Organisations to continue to share any cost of construction data that they have already collected, or are collecting using the format which can be downloaded [here](#). Please share the data with Anu Prasai, HRRP National General Coordination Officer, nco1@hrrpnepal.org, who you can also contact if you have any questions or wish to provide any feedback.

Digital Internship and Leadership Programme, Kathmandu Living Labs: this opportunity is available to students and recent graduates who are looking to develop digital skills and to improve leadership and creative skills. The internship is for a period of three months and successful applicants will contribute to the expansion of a free, editable, digital map of Nepal using Open Street Map. For more information about the internship program, you can contact Pradip Khatiwada, youthpradip@gmail.com / 9841900488, or Kshitiz Khanal, khanal1990@gmail.com / 9841857952.

Global Migration Film Festival, 5-18 December: organised by IOM, the festival showcases films that capture the promise and challenges of migration for those who leave their homes in search of a better life and the contributions they make to their new communities.

Government of Nepal

Launch of MoFALD Local Governance Website, Mobile App, and Knowledge Management Blog (Nepali, Unofficial English Translation): the Ministry of Federal Affairs and Local Development (MOFALD), with support from the Local Governance and Community Development Programme (LGCDP), last week launched a [new interactive GIS website](#), mobile app, and knowledge management blog as part of the process of establishing and promoting e-governance across the 753 local governments throughout the country.

HRRP

HRRP Cost of Construction Infographic: the HRRP DCTs collected [information on costs of construction in October 2017](#) through phone calls with 570 households across the 14 districts most affected by the earthquakes. Whilst it seems that accessing finance is not a major hurdle for many households, it does seem that we may be facing a potential debt crisis. With more than 50% of households taking loans to finance on average 50% of the total cost of their home, at often extortionate interest rates, there is a real risk that indebtedness will hamper the long-term recovery of thousands of households and communities. HRRP and DFID have been collaborating on efforts to move forward some further research in this area - if you are interested to get involved please contact the HRRP Recovery Advisor, Siobhan Kennedy, siobhan@hrrpnepal.org.

HOUSING CONSTRUCTION COSTS OCTOBER 2017

Full report available on the HRRP
website: <https://goo.gl/kL6Dc4>



1. How much did your house cost / do you estimate it will cost?

2. What building materials did you use / are you planning to use and have you salvaged materials?

3. Do you plan to / have you already taken a loan and if so for how much, from what type of financial institution, and at what interest rate?



\$ 6,500

Median Cost of Construction,
14 Most Affected Districts

DISTRICT	MEDIAN (NPRS)	LOWEST (NPRS)	HIGHEST (NPRS)
Bhaktapur	2,500,000	700,000	4,200,000
Dhading	800,000	200,000	2,500,000
Dolakha	550,000	300,000	2,600,000
Gorkha	700,000	150,000	3,500,000
Kathmandu	2,250,000	200,000	6,500,000
Kavre	600,000	300,000	3,000,000
Lalitpur	1,200,000	75,000	6,000,000
Makwanpur	575,000	50,000	3,200,000
Nuwakot	650,000	200,000	6,500,000
Okhaldhunga	500,000	250,000	1,400,000
Ramechhap	600,000	300,000	3,500,000
Rasuwa	700,000	300,000	1,700,000
Sindhuli	1,000,000	700,000	1,600,000
Sindhupalchowk	600,000	280,000	4,000,000
OVERALL MEDIAN	675,000	265,000	3,350,000

56% of respondents have taken, or are planning to take, a loan to finance the reconstruction of their home.



Average interest rate is 23%, ranging from 0% to 43%.



On average, loan amount represents 50% of total construction costs.

Are we looking at a potential debt crisis?

- 767,705 households are eligible for the 300,000 NPRs reconstruction grant from the GoN (as of 23 November)
- If 400,000 of these households take a loan of 3,250 USD, that is **1.3 billion USD in debt**
- The high interest rates many households are paying may mean that their long term recovery will be heavily affected by indebtedness

Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps: based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 22 November.

[Partnership Agreement Signed between HH and GoN](#)

[1st Tranche Received](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[Compliance Rate – 2nd Tranche](#)

[Compliance Rate – 3rd Tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

HRRP District Profiles: based on HRRP 4W R42, 10 November. We have made some changes to the district profile template – please feel free to share any feedback on the changes to im.national@hrrpnepal.org.

[Bhaktapur](#)

[Dhading](#)

[Dolakha](#)

[Gorkha](#)

[Kathmandu](#)

[Kavrepalanchok](#)

[Lalitpur](#)

[Makwanpur](#)

[Nuwakot](#)

[Okhaldhunga](#)

[Ramechhap](#)

[Rasuwa](#)

[Sindhuli](#)

[Sindhupalchok](#)

Partners

Milijuli Nepali, Episode 802: this episode was recorded in Gangajamuna Rural Municipality, Ward 4, Phalange, Dhading. The programme tries to give a flavour of how construction workers are working in the villages. The episode begins with presenter Subash Karki arriving at Dhan Kumari Simkhada's house where construction work was being carried out. Dhan Kumari shared how they are contributing to the construction of their own house. The presenter also works along with the construction workers chopping timber. The construction workers talk about building techniques that make the houses resilient, treatment of timber, and how houses built before the earthquake are different from houses built after the earthquake.

Baliyo Ghar TV Programme, Episode 80: this week's episode is focused on reconstruction Stories from Northern Dhading. Baliyo Ghar is aired each week live on Kantipur TV on Monday at, 7:30PM, News24 TV on Wed at 8:00AM and Avenues TV on Saturday at 8:30AM with twice repeat from each for a week.

USAID Nepal, Open for Business - Story of Mamata B.K.: Mamata B.K., a married mother of two from southern Nepal, used to dream of opening up her own shop and becoming a business woman. But as a female growing up as a Dalit—a marginalised caste considered as an “untouchable”—her prospects of fulfilling her dream were slim. Then one day, she enrolled in a USAID training program for women in which she learned leadership and small business development skills, joined a savings and loan group, and used seed money to open a small retail shop in her village.

Asian Development Outlook (ADO) 2017 Update: the outlook update forecasts that 'Developing Asia's' GDP will grow by 5.9% in 2017 and 5.8% in 2018. The update report is accompanied by [18 related datasets which are available for download](#), including 'Current Account Balance in Asia and the Pacific' and 'Debt Service Ratio in Asia and the Pacific'.

[Media Digest](#) | [FAQ](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [4W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)